

Chapter 2

Millionaire Myth: The Wealthy Didn't Earn and Don't Deserve Their Money

“Look at him. I bet he’s never worked a day in his life.”

I hear statements like that all the time—in the news I read, on the shows I watch, and from the people I meet, and I bet you have, too. It drives me crazy when people make snap judgments about strangers. I remember a time when this kind of thoughtless rhetoric was directed at the poor or the homeless. Nowadays, though, it seems like people are more likely to fling baseless insults and assumptions at the wealthy. They see someone who is winning, and their first reaction is to think, *Look at Daddy’s little princess. Must be nice to have such rich parents.* Or maybe, *Those hands have never done an honest day’s work.* Thinking these things is bad enough, but it absolutely drives me crazy when someone actually says something like that out loud. When someone I know goes off on a little tantrum about how “easy” rich people have it, I get both irritated and frustrated! To me, it’s the worst form of whining, and I don’t have time for it in my life—and neither do you.

Statements like these perpetuate one of the most annoying, flat-out-false myths I’ve ever heard about wealthy people: that they’ve had everything handed to them. This myth is based on jealousy, envy, and ignorance, and you’ve got to get past those things if you want to join the millionaire ranks